DIGITAL LITERACY – PROJECT

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BRANCH: BTECH (AI AND ML)

YEAR: 2025 – 2029

COURSE TITLE: DIGITAL LITERACY

COURSE CODE: CSE0001

DATE: 29/03/2026

INTRODUCTION

The Digital Literacy Project (CSE0001) offered by VIT Bhopal University seeks to create Student Digital Ambassadors from BTech First Year students, capable of succeeding in today's technologically advanced environment. The primary objective of this assignment is to create a Digital Literacy Portfolio, a professional presentation of a student's ability to communicate safely, responsibly, and effectively within an online environment. The Digital Literacy Portfolio is hosted within a GitHub repository, making it not only accessible for grading but also as a permanent component of the student's professional online presence.

The product of the entire process is a well-organized GitHub repository, and a project report outlining all the work carried out technically, observations, and reflections for each of the modules. This project is assessed on a

Pass/Fail basis. The rationale for the project is to ensure the students have a toolset knowledge of digital citizenship without any previous coding knowledge. By completing the entire assignment as a Digital Ambassador, the students have the opportunity to develop a foundational toolset of knowledge that is beneficial to them throughout their academic and professional lives in the digital world.

TASK-1: INFOGRAPHIC

Tool used: Piktochart

Topics covered: What digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices.

Write up:

The first stage of the Digital Literacy project is focused on the creation of a one-page infographic visual representation, which is referred to as Digital Literacy Basics. The purpose of this infographic visual representation is educational, targeting the student's peer group. The infographic visual representation is created using a professional tool, i.e., “Piktochart” which offers valuable insights related to the broad concept of digital literacy. The visual representation of the infographic highlights the importance of the three basic pillars of digital literacy which include seeking information, meaning of digital literacy, the use of basic

digital tools, and online safety, The infographic visual representation effectively highlights the importance of the critical thinking skills of the individual while seeking information, avoiding the spread of misinformation, and so on. The most interesting part of the task was striking the right balance between aesthetic appeal and informativeness, so that the 'Digital Ambassador' task was carried out successfully.

TASK-2: DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

Platforms used: GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle

Write up:

This task is centered around the primary requirement of creating a professional digital presence through significant academic and industry-oriented platforms. In this case, three platforms are being utilized for the construction of this digital portfolio. These platforms are GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. In the case of GitHub, a specialized profile README was created to highlight the student's core academic information. This includes the branch of the student, the year of their studies, and a statement about their learning objectives. In addition to this, the LinkedIn profile was also updated to reflect the student's enrollment at VIT Bhopal University to ensure their presence at a global level. Kaggle was also integrated into this digital portfolio as a space for future data science projects. In the project report, the rationale for the choice of these

platforms is based on their importance in the contemporary engineering world, such as GitHub for version control, LinkedIn for networking, and Kaggle for technical development. The write-up also discusses the maintenance of these profiles in the next four years, developing from a simple student profile to a comprehensive professional profile.

TASK-3: PLATTFORMS

Platforms used: Hacker Rank, Forms

Write up:

This is to ensure that there is a level of technical knowledge of coding platforms and cloud-based collaboration tools that are often used in the field and are a necessity for a Student Digital Ambassador. When it comes to the actual application of the technical side of the application, an account was created on Hacker Rank, and a beginner-level challenge titled "Solve Me First" was completed to ensure knowledge of programming logic for a beginner. This bridges the gap between knowledge and application, which is a necessity for any upcoming tests or placements.

The second task is to create a google form with the help of forms available in google which contains exactly five questions on the topic “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz”. It is further divided into two parts in which the first part

contains three multiple choice questions, and the second part consists of two short answer type questions based on the above-mentioned topic i.e., “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz”. This is done to test the digital knowledge for one who is responding to this google form. This demonstrates proficiency in using diverse digital ecosystems for both skill development and academic collaboration.

TASK-4: Email etiquette, Checklist

Write up:

The first task consists of drafting two formal emails in which the first one is to request the professor to extend the deadline of assignment submission which could not be able to complete it on time by the student. The next one is to an internship coordinator at a company expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. Both the emails are written in a formal way, and it follows all professional email writing rules with a clear subject line, professional greeting, and a proper sign off.

The next is to create a checklist on "5 Do's and 5 Don'ts for responsible social media use as a college student". This checklist is made as most of the students are losing all their personal information that leads to many troubles, on following these Do's and Don'ts one can safely use his/her without losing any of their information in various media platforms which leads to many threats and thefts. By

mastering these rules mentioned, the student ensures that their professional identity remains consistent across all digital channels. This also ensures misuse of social media and is only used for academic purposes.

TASK-5: CYBERCRIME CASE STUDY

Write up:

The last module enables the student digital ambassador to play a protective role in identifying and migrating online threats. This task is about a detailed case study of one of the major cybercrimes which is “Identity Theft” i.e., stealing one’s personal information and using it for their own benefit. This type of cybercrime threat is now very common as most users are not keeping their personal information safe and secure. It is recorded that at least 10 cases per day have been filed due to identity theft. The one thing that is surprising in identity theft is that using only a few pieces of information is combined to hijack a person’s entire digital life.

Followed by the case study of cybercrime the next is to make a checklist on “stay safe online” with at least 8 specific prevention tips relevant to college students in India. This resource is intended to be a direct guide for

your college peers to avoid the threats from cybercrime. This proactive approach, along with knowledge of the National Cyber Crime Portal (1930), offers a much greater level of security regarding online fraud. As such, one change in the habits of an individual should be the implementation of multi-factor authentication (MFA) for all primary accounts, along with the privacy settings of social media.

CONCLUSIONS

The entire experience has provided a holistic view of the digital world, going well beyond the basic technology aspects and entering the realms of professional identity, global collaboration, and advanced security awareness. By the structured process of the five main modules, a basic digital portfolio has been established through the use of GitHub as a permanent record of professional preparedness. I learned many new things on completing the project like how to keep one's personal information in social media safe and secure without anyone from hijacking it, how to create a portfolio. My coding skills also improved way more than before by practicing a trusted coding platform like Hacker Rank. I also learnt a new skill of prompt writing which helps me to get the perfect infographic/presentation that i require and it reaches my requirements. The resulting repository is more than just an academic submission; it is a launchpad for a

four-year engineering journey at VIT Bhopal University and a critical asset for future career opportunities in the global digital economy.

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